

Toyama: A Sustainable Regional City

What We Can Learn from Toyama, Japan

Kai Yamaguchi | Jilin University Workshop: My Idea of a Sustainable City



Photo taken by the presenter

Why Toyama Chose a Compact City Model

Background

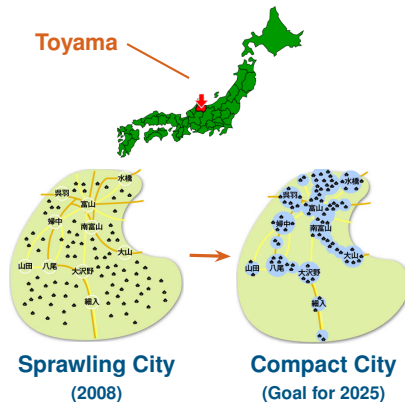
Located on the Sea of Japan coast, Toyama is a regional city outside Japan's major metropolitan areas. Like many regional cities, it faces a shrinking and aging population.

Problem

Toyama has developed as a low-density, car-dependent city. This makes it harder for people without cars to get around and for the city to maintain public services.

Approach

Toyama promotes **a compact city model** based on public transport and concentrated urban functions.



In 2008, homes were spread over a wide area. This is called **urban sprawl**. The city aims to gather homes and services near stations.

Three Features of Sustainable Toyama

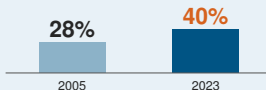


1 Light Rail (LRT)

People can get around **without relying too much on cars**.

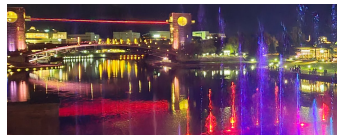
Low-floor vehicles make public transport easier to use, especially for older people. The LRT is a key part of Toyama's compact-city strategy.

Residents near good public transport



2 Compact City

Toyama encourages homes, shops, hospitals, and other urban functions to locate along public transport corridors. The share of residents in these areas increased from **28%** in 2005 to **40%** by 2023.



3 Kansui Park

Kansui Park is a large waterside park about a nine-minute walk from Toyama Station. Its waterfront, green space, and walking paths provide a pleasant place to walk and relax.

For me, a sustainable city is not just efficient.

It should be easy to get around, comfortable to live in, and enjoyable to spend time in.

Toyama shows how public transport, compact planning, and attractive public spaces can work together.